pay for them and put them away, and let them incubate with such patience as is attributed to the hopeful setting hen.

The student of the stock market has at certain periods no easy task before him. Imports are sometimes large, and exports small. We sell to foreigners a million per week of cotton, and buy from them two millions per week of coffee, the cotton yielding us a small profit, the coffee yielding foreigners an immense profit. Other nations at times do not seem to prefer our grains to those of Russia and the East, despite those foreign markets of bewildering extent and good prices which exist, I fear, only in the imagination of free-traders. Then, too, the indebtedness of corporations and individuals acts as a constant menace to the natural tendency of loose capital to be lent out to useful enterprises.

Some financial teachers lay it down that your risks should not exceed 25 per cent. of your capital. This is excessive prudence; but the man who keeps half a mile away from the edge of a cliff will never fall from it.

Yet, at the bottom of all this turbulent mass of facts there are natural laws at work which, if we study them in relation to the objects which they control, will be found to be as sure in their operation as sunrise. The collapse of the iniquitous coal combination, as cruel as one to raise the price of water or air, was the result of natural law, and the same laws are busy to-day, and the facts are always with us. It is the business of the diligent to find them and to profit thereby.